

AI Tools for Grant Research

AI can save you hours finding grants, writing applications, and planning your business — if you use it wisely. Below is how to use AI safely and well. Tick the box once you've tried each step.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

AI is a powerful research assistant, but it can be wrong or out of date. Always double-check what it tells you against official sources before applying or relying on it. Never share sensitive personal info you wouldn't want stored.

1 Use AI to Find Grants Faster

Let AI do the first pass, then verify everything.

☐ Ask the Lesko Help AI Search

Our community's AI is built to find grants and programs for your situation. Start here for the most relevant results.

→ **Use the Lesko Help AI Search**

☐ Verify on Grants.gov

Always confirm any grant AI suggests on the official site before applying.

→ www.grants.gov

2 Use AI to Write & Plan

AI can draft and polish — you provide the truth and final say.

☐ Draft Applications & Plans

Ask AI to draft a business plan section or grant answer, then edit it to be true and specific to you.

→ **Use the Lesko Help AI tools**

☐ Improve, Don't Invent

Use AI to improve grammar and clarity — but never let it invent facts, numbers, or credentials.

→ **Always fact-check AI output**

3 Stay Safe With AI

A few habits keep you protected and accurate.

☐ Double-Check Deadlines & Amounts

AI may give outdated grant info. Confirm deadlines and dollar amounts on official sites.

→ **Verify on the official program site**

☐ Protect Your Information

Don't paste sensitive data (SSN, bank details) into AI tools.

→ **Keep sensitive info out of AI chats**

4 Get Better Results

How to ask AI for what you actually need.

☐ Be Specific in Your Requests

Tell the AI your location, industry, and situation for sharper results. The more detail, the better the matches.

→ Ask in the Questions area for tips

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

AI can “hallucinate” — it sometimes invents grants, links, or deadlines that don’t exist. Treat every AI answer as a lead to verify, not a final fact, especially before you apply or spend money.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Use AI for the time-consuming first draft — finding options and writing rough text — then bring your real numbers and double-check the details. That combination saves hours without risking mistakes.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Want help using AI for your business?

Our community’s AI tools are built for exactly this. For hands-on help finding grants or drafting an application with AI, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we’ll guide you.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
